

Financially Sovereign Academy

Correctional and Reentry Program

Budgeting & Emergency Savings

Investor / Partner Preview

Version 0.1 (provisional) · 2026-07-04

Provisional pilot-ready draft. External counsel review pending. Not for final facility distribution until legal/privacy feedback is reconciled.

Described as pilot-ready, never proven or validated. No outcome or recidivism claims.
Not legally approved. Source & Claims Ledger held at v0.2.

Budgeting & Emergency Savings for Reentry: Investor / Partner Preview

Program: Correctional and Reentry | Preview version: v0.1 | Date: 2026-07-04

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This preview shows the program's structure, learner relevance, exercises, implementation model, and pilot pathway. It is a curated overview, not the operational facility packet, and it omits internal legal and privacy operating detail. The program is described as pilot-ready. It does not claim proven outcomes, validated impact, recidivism reduction, or guaranteed behavior change.

1. Program overview

A paper-first, four-session financial decision-making module (plus an optional fifth capstone) for people rebuilding after incarceration. It runs on paper and pencil, prints in black and white, and needs no internet, phones, or calculators, so it works in almost any correctional or reentry setting. It teaches budgeting as triage under pressure and savings as a small shock absorber, not category tracking and not a wealth plan. Each session is standalone and usable on its own, which fits the reality of rotating rooms and irregular attendance.

The one-sentence spine: when money is short, the skill is slowing the damage, protecting the next step, asking early, and keeping one option open.

2. Why this program exists

In the first 90 days after release, money in is irregular (gate money, family help, day labor, first paychecks) and money out is fixed and stacked (supervision costs, child support, phone, transport, housing contribution, work clothes). A budget built like a spreadsheet dies on contact with one bad week. One small shock, a bus pass, a tool, a fee, can break the whole month, and the pressure moment that follows is exactly when the most expensive options appear: payday and title loans, cash-advance apps, informal borrowing with social strings, family conflict. Most financial education assumes steady income and a bank account. This program is built for the opposite.

3. Who it serves

Adults in correctional and reentry settings, in a deliberately mixed room: people weeks to months from release working with estimates, and people recently out working with real numbers. Mixed literacy and numeracy. Some have never run a household; others ran one and lost it. It works even for a learner with no ID, phone, bank account, or job yet. Delivered by a facility facilitator or a trained partner facilitator.

4. What makes it different from generic financial literacy

- **Triage, not tracking.** The core skill is deciding what gets paid when everything cannot be paid: stay housed, stay fed, stay legal, stay working.
- **Built for irregular income,** not a steady paycheck that most learners do not yet have.
- **Decision practice, not memorization.** Learners sort real pressures and defend their order, rather than recall definitions.
- **Reentry-specific pressures** are the material: supervision and court fees, family money asks, fast-money traps aimed at the recently released.
- **Honest scope.** It teaches decisions and questions and routes legal or case-specific matters to the right office or free legal aid. It never gives legal, tax, or case advice.
- **Paper-first and constraint-proof,** so it runs where laptops and phones cannot.

5. Session map

Session	Title	Focus
1	Where the Money Goes	See irregular money honestly; a one-week money map on paper
2	Plan to the Floor	Plan around a floor that survives a good week and a bad week
3	The Conversations	The early ask, in writing; answering a family money ask without burning the relationship
4	Shocks, Traps, and the Plan	Emergencies, fast-money traps, true cost, and a plan that holds
5 (optional)	Capstone / review	Consolidation; usable as a standalone review

Four sessions of about 90 minutes, each standalone. The optional capstone can be added or held out of a first pilot.

6. Sample learner exercises and scenarios

- **One-week money map (Session 1):** on a single sheet, the learner lays out irregular money in and stacked money out, in estimates or real numbers.
- **Bill-card sort (Session 2):** identical paper slips carry common pressures (rent, a family member asking, a court fee, phone, food, a ride to work). The learner sorts them into pay now / negotiate / later and defends the order.
- **“What is the real price of this offer?” (Session 4):** a set of realistic fast-money offers (a payday route, a cash-advance app, a pawn, a title loan). The

learner picks the least expensive option and says why, using a least-harm frame rather than a lecture.

- **The practiced sentence (Session 3):** the learner writes and rehearses one line to answer a family money ask, protecting both the budget and the relationship.
- **Emergency definition drill (Session 4):** the learner writes a one-line personal definition of an emergency and tests it against scenarios, including naming a realistic first cushion rung, which can be “zero this week, with a date.”

All dollar amounts in scenarios are labeled examples.

7. Sample facilitator supports

- A facilitator guide with session-by-session notes and a clear one-line boundary: facilitators teach decisions and questions, never answers to legal or personal-case questions.
- Ready routing scripts for the predictable hard questions (supervision and court fees, child support, medication costs), each routing to the right office or free legal aid and helping the learner write the question down to walk in ready.
- Discipline built in for a correctional room: no forced sharing, no public dollar amounts, no ranking, de-escalation and step-out handled without spectacle.

8. Implementation model

Paper-first, pencil-only, black-and-white printable, no internet, phones, or calculators, hand-math only. A facility implementation guide and a memorandum of understanding cover setup: who facilitates, materials handling, a local resource sheet built and verified for that site, and a short data-handling agreement. Two delivery tracks (preparing-for-release and recently-released) share worksheets wherever possible, with variants only where clarity requires them. The design goal is that a facility can run it with modest training and minimal equipment.

9. Assessment approach (aggregate only)

An optional pre/post measure of decision-making and confidence, built for this curriculum. It is described as a program-built measure, not a validated scale, and is never called validated in any report or grant language. Reporting is aggregate only: cohort average pre and post decision scores, average change, average confidence change, number of participants, and nothing identifying. Scores are never used to rank, gate, shame, or report on an individual. The purpose is to describe, in aggregate, how decision scores and confidence changed, and to improve the class.

10. Privacy-conscious design (external review pending)

Privacy is treated as a core design commitment, not a footnote. At a high level: learners use their own self-chosen codes rather than names, individual results are not designed to be attributable by the program, results are shared only in aggregate, data collection is minimized, and retention is short. The full privacy and legal-boundary language is under external counsel review now, before any final facility distribution.

Operational specifics are handled in the facility agreement rather than in learner materials.

11. Partner-network model

The program is built to run through partners rather than alone. Priority partners include reentry nonprofits, correctional education directors, county jails with reentry coordinators, workforce development boards, CDFIs and credit unions with community reinvestment goals, municipal offices of financial empowerment, community colleges with reentry programs, legal-aid reentry clinics, housing reentry programs, and faith-based reentry organizations. A partner-network checklist and a trusted-partner agreement keep delivery consistent and the boundaries intact. The program sells no products and takes no compensated referrals.

12. Pilot pathway

A facility or partner can start a pilot in one of four ways: - **A. Facility runs it** with our materials. - **B. We train the facility's facilitator.** - **C. We deliver the first cohort** and hand off. - **D. Partner pilot** with a local reentry nonprofit.

Each pilot includes the four sessions (plus optional capstone), the facilitator guide, the implementation guide, the optional assessment and follow-up survey, the partner checklist, and an aggregate reporting template.

13. What funding supports

Funding supports facilitator training, materials production and printing, building and verifying the local resource sheet for each site, first-cohort delivery, aggregate reporting, and partner coordination. Natural funding lanes, framed as financial stabilization: reentry services, justice-involved workforce development, correctional education, municipal financial empowerment and Bank On ecosystems, and private foundations focused on reentry, workforce development, financial capability, and housing stability. The best first path is a partner-led pilot paired with a local foundation, city, reentry nonprofit, or workforce board.

14. Current status and remaining gates

- Full four-session curriculum, facilitator guide, implementation guide, assessment, follow-up survey, partner checklist, and funder overview are drafted and internally audited.
- The provisional pilot packet is assembled for formatting and proofing.
- **External counsel review is pending:** a scoped review brief covering privacy, assessment, and facilitator-boundary language has been sent. Counsel approval has not been received.
- The source and claims ledger is held at v0.2; its final legal review close is the remaining gate and is not yet done.
- Remaining before a pilot offer: counsel dispositions reconciled, final review close, a small set of owner sign-offs, a proof pass, and the pilot-option decision.

Status in one line: provisional pilot-ready, external legal and privacy review in progress, not yet offered to any facility, and described as pilot-ready rather than proven.

This is an investor and partner preview. It is not the facility distribution packet and not a final release. Nothing here is legally approved, and the program makes no claims of proven outcomes, validated impact, recidivism reduction, or guaranteed financial stability.